



Smart DJ

User Manual

Marketing Version 1.1 • Build 54 • September 2026

A practical guide to setup, playlist management, smart selection, playback, and troubleshooting.

1. Overview

Smart DJ is a multi-platform music-selection app designed to choose and start music using a simple weekday schedule, random playlist selection, favorite playlists, Discovery Station, and New Music Station.

The current project supports Apple Music on macOS, iOS, tvOS, and watchOS, and Spotify on macOS and iOS. Apple Music playback uses an in-app MusicKit catalog request on macOS, iOS, and tvOS; watchOS opens the stored Apple Music link directly because a MusicKit player is not available there. Spotify playback on macOS and iOS uses the stored Spotify link through Spotify's Web API. Smart DJ uses iCloud Key-Value Store to synchronize its shared configuration and Recent History across supported platforms. All supported platforms read the shared Smart DJ data when the app starts. macOS and iOS can edit the full supported shared configuration; tvOS/watchOS can update Favorite and Christmas classifications.

What Smart DJ does

- Reads the music-service playlist library and builds the Smart DJ playlist catalog.
- Marks playlists as Favorite and/or Christmas playlists.
- Selects music automatically according to the weekday schedule.
- Avoids recently played playlists and, outside December, excludes playlists marked Christmas.
- Keeps a rolling shared history of the 10 most recently selected ordinary playlists.
- Shows the currently playing track, artist, album, and artwork where the platform supports it.
- Provides previous, play/pause, and next controls.
- Supports Siri, Shortcuts, Spotlight, and other system surfaces through Smart DJ App Intents/App Shortcuts for the five Smart DJ modes; no separately built Apple Shortcut is required for playback.
- Provides CarPlay audio integration on iOS.
- Provides iPhone/iPad Home Screen widgets for Quick Play and Now Playing.

Playlist Management Scope

Smart DJ manages the selection and playback of existing playlists and music stations. It does not create, modify, reorder, or delete playlists or their contents. Playlist creation and editing remain functions of Apple Music or Spotify.

Smart DJ does maintain its own playback-related information, including Favorite and Christmas classifications, station links, the weekly schedule, and playback history. These settings do not alter the underlying Apple Music or Spotify playlists.

2. Smart DJ modes

<u>Mode</u>	<u>How it selects</u>	<u>Typical use</u>
Today's Schedule	Uses the weekday schedule below.	One-button daily choice.
Random Playlist	Randomly selects from eligible ordinary playlists.	General variety.
Favorite Playlist	Randomly selects from playlists marked Favorite.	Preferred music.
Discovery Station	Uses the stored catalog-resource URL to identify and start the exact station.	Personalized discovery.
New Music Station	Uses the stored catalog-resource URL to identify and start the exact station.	Recent/new releases.

3. The weekday schedule

Important: Each day has an editable setting to select from 1) Random playlist, 2) Discovery Station, 3) New Music Station, 4) Favorite playlist. The schedule is determined by the user. A sample schedule is shown below:

<u>Day</u>	<u>Smart DJ choice</u>
Monday	Discovery Station
Tuesday	Random playlist
Wednesday	New Music Station
Thursday	Random playlist
Friday	Discovery Station
Saturday	Random playlist
Sunday	Favorite playlist

4. First-time setup — Mac

1. Launch Smart DJ.
2. Open Settings from the app's macOS Settings window.
3. Under Music Service, choose Apple Music or Spotify.
4. For Apple Music, the app may request permission to access the Music library. Allow it.
5. Smart DJ shared configuration is synchronized through iCloud Key-Value Store. No shared Smart DJ data folder is required for Favorites, Christmas classifications, Discovery Station data, New Music Station data, playlist/link data, or Recent History.
6. Return to the main window and use Reload if necessary.
7. Open Playlists and review the imported playlist catalog.
8. Use the Favorite and Christmas columns to classify playlists, then choose Save.

When iCloud is available, Smart DJ reads the shared key-value data at startup. Changes made on macOS are written back to the shared iCloud data so other supported platforms can read the updated configuration.

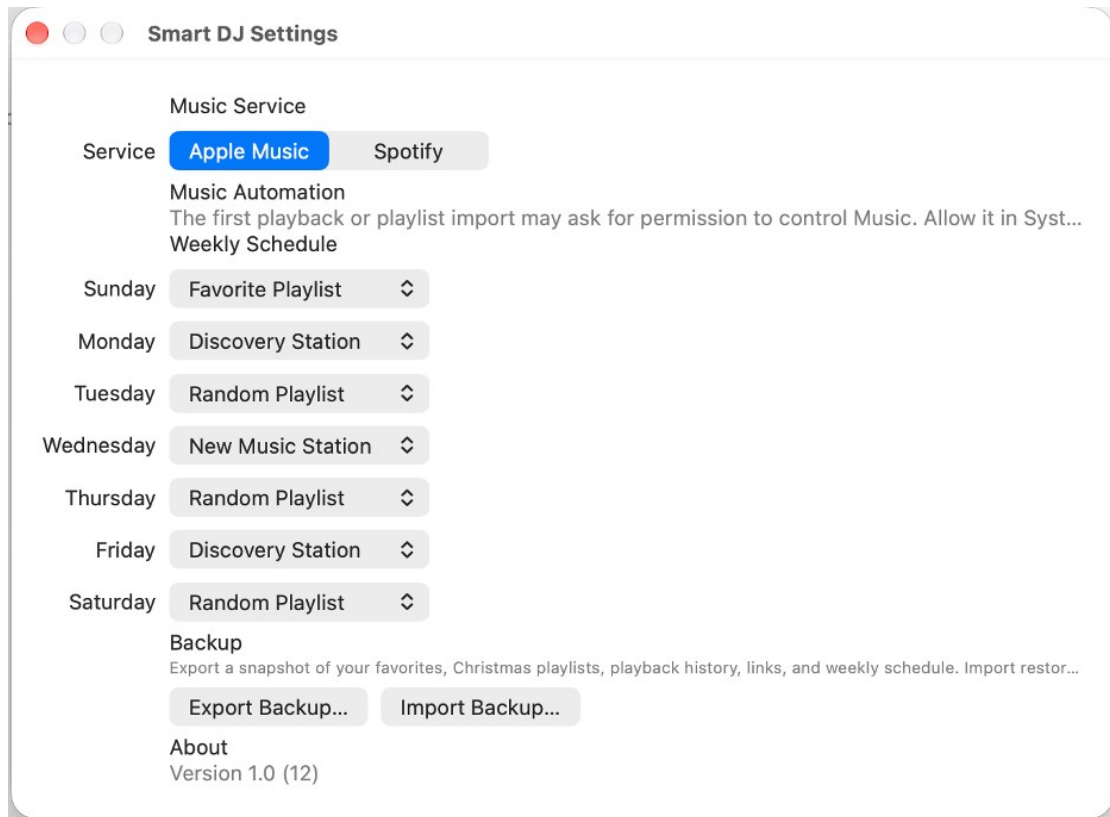


Figure 1 - Smart DJ Settings and Weekly Schedule on macOS. Select Apple Music or Spotify, assign a playback mode independently to each day of the week, and use Export Backup or Import Backup for manual JSON backup and restore. Shared configuration and history synchronize through iCloud Key-Value Store.

5. First-time setup — iPhone/iPad

9. Install and launch Smart DJ.
10. Open Settings.
11. Choose Apple Music or Spotify.
12. Smart DJ automatically reads its shared configuration and Recent History from iCloud Key-Value Store when the app starts; no shared-folder selection is required for synchronization.
13. Confirm that iCloud is available for the device so Smart DJ can access the shared key-value data. In Settings, choose Apple Music or Spotify and review the Playback information.
14. Configure the Weekly Schedule as desired. Each day can use Random Playlist, Favorite Playlist, Discovery Station, or New Music Station.
15. Optional: use Export Backup to save a snapshot of Smart DJ data to a .json file, or Import Backup to restore a previous snapshot. If Apple Music requests permission, allow access to the Music library.

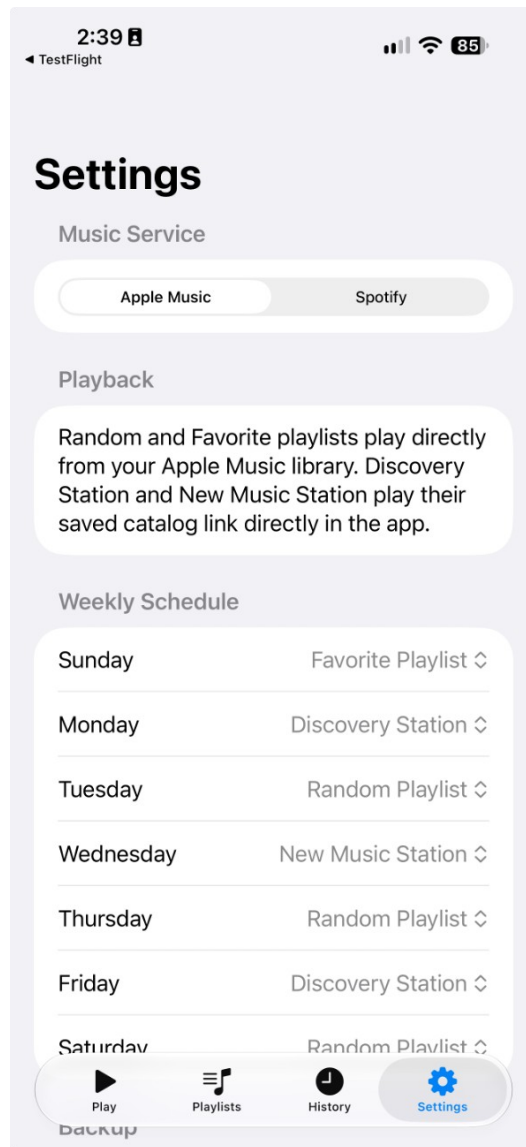


Figure 2A - Smart DJ Settings on iPhone. Select Apple Music or Spotify, review playback behavior, and configure the Weekly Schedule. Shared Smart DJ data is synchronized through iCloud Key-Value Store, so no shared-folder setup is required.

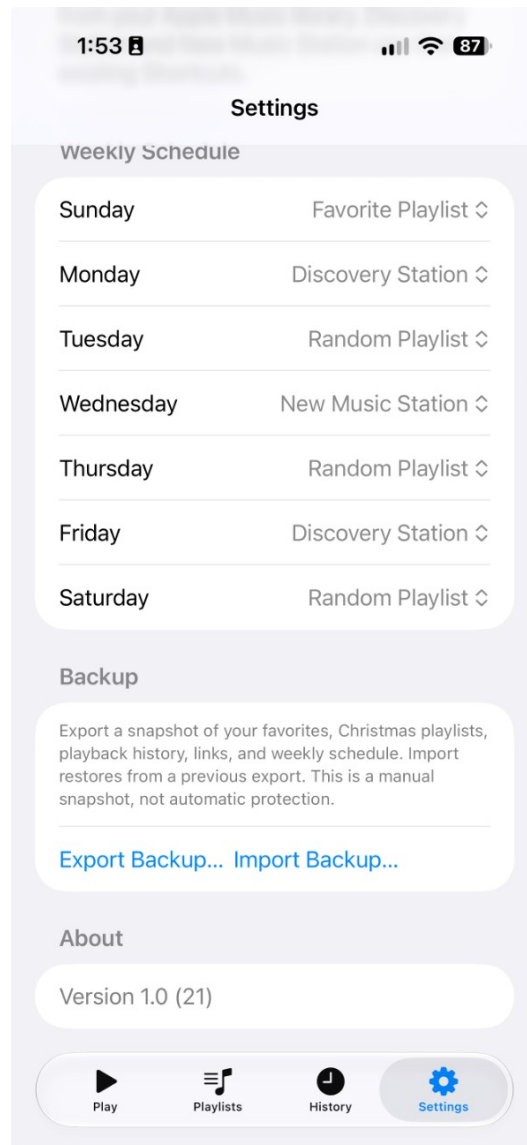


Figure 2B - Backup and Weekly Schedule on iPhone. Export Backup creates a manual .json snapshot of Favorites, Christmas classifications, playback history, links, and the weekly schedule; Import Backup restores a previous snapshot.

Shared-data principle: Favorites, Christmas classifications, Discovery Station data, New Music Station data, playlist/link data, and Recent History are stored in iCloud Key-Value Store. All supported platforms read the shared data at startup. macOS and iOS can edit the full supported shared configuration; tvOS/watchOS can update Favorite and Christmas classifications.

6. Using the Play screen

Today's Schedule

The top card shows the current weekday and the mode that will be used. Tap or click Play Today's Schedule to run it.

Random Playlist

Select Random Playlist to choose an ordinary playlist at random. Recent-history and Christmas rules are applied before the final random choice.

Favorite Playlist

Select Favorite Playlist to choose randomly from playlists marked Favorite. The same recent-history and Christmas rules apply.

Discovery Station and New Music Station

Discovery Station and New Music Station are catalog resources rather than ordinary playlists in the user's personal library, so they cannot be resolved by playlist-name lookup. For Apple Music on macOS, iOS, and tvOS, Smart DJ uses the stored URL to identify the catalog resource. Smart DJ parses the URL path to determine the catalog kind (station or playlist) and catalog ID, then a `MusicCatalogResourceRequest` fetches that exact resource for in-app playback. On watchOS, Smart DJ opens the stored Apple Music link directly because a `MusicKit` player is not available there. For Spotify on macOS and iOS, the stored URL identifies the resource that Spotify's Web API starts playing. Without the stored URL, Smart DJ cannot determine which Discovery Station or New Music Station catalog resource to play; these resources cannot be resolved by name alone.

Current playback behavior: Discovery Station and New Music Station play directly through Smart DJ. On Apple Music, Smart DJ resolves the stored catalog URL and starts the resource in-app on macOS, iOS, and tvOS; on Spotify, Smart DJ uses the stored Spotify identifier through the Web API on macOS and iOS.

Now Playing

On iOS and macOS, the Now Playing card shows artwork, playlist, track, artist, and album. A song-time progress bar shows playback position, with elapsed time on the left and remaining time on the right. The card also provides previous, play/pause, and next controls. The app refreshes Now Playing information approximately every three seconds. On tvOS, Smart DJ intentionally uses a simplified playback view with previous, play/pause, and next controls but does not duplicate track metadata in the app, because library-sourced Now Playing metadata is not consistently available there. Spotify playback is not supported on tvOS.

Open in Music Service

Open In Apple Music / Open In Spotify hands playback off to the selected music service. On macOS, the current build places this command in the window toolbar so it remains visible even in shorter windows. On iPhone/iPad, the Open In control remains on the Play screen.

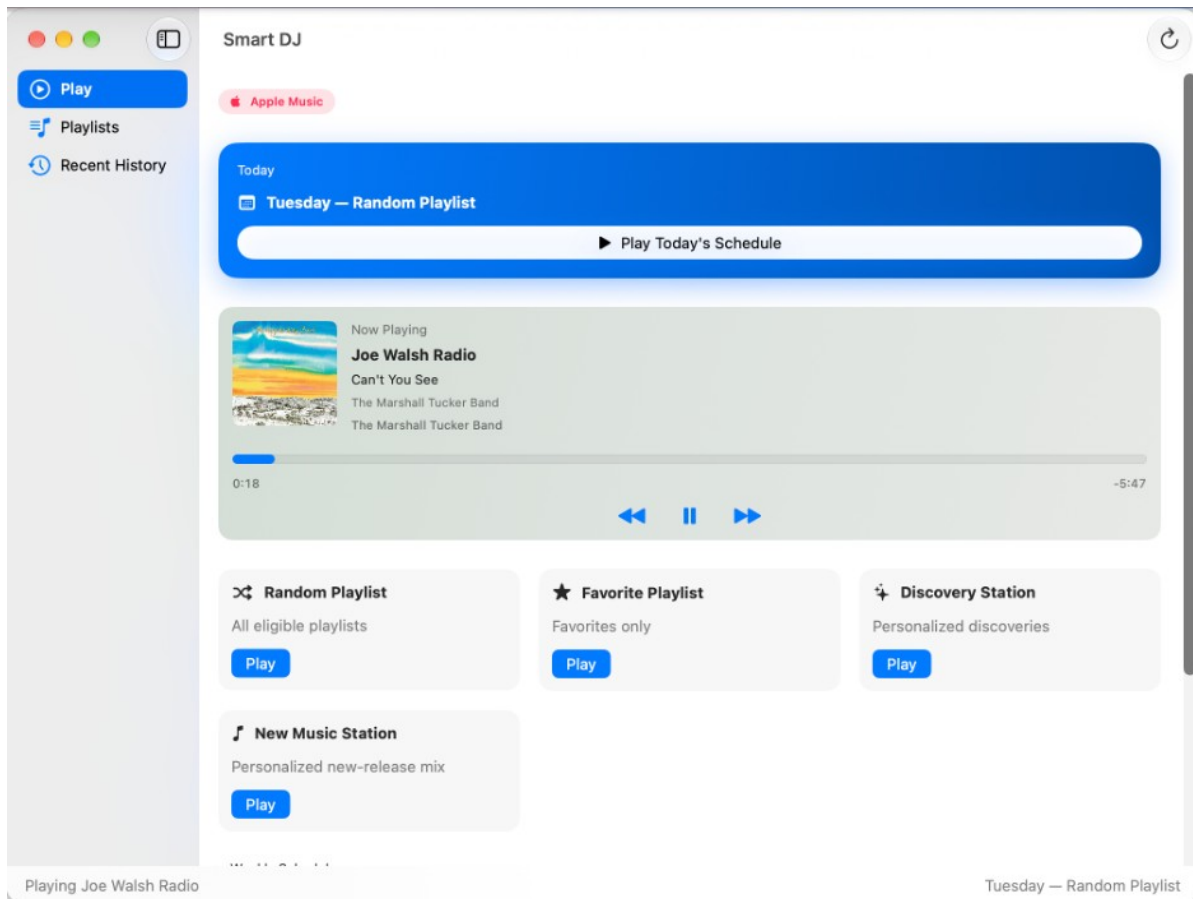


Figure 3 - Smart DJ Play screen on macOS with Apple Music selected. The Now Playing panel shows album artwork, current track information, a song-time progress bar with elapsed and remaining time, and previous, play/pause, and next controls. Today's Schedule and the four direct playback modes remain available on the same screen. In Marketing Version 1.1, the Open In music-service command is located in the macOS toolbar so it remains visible at shorter window heights.

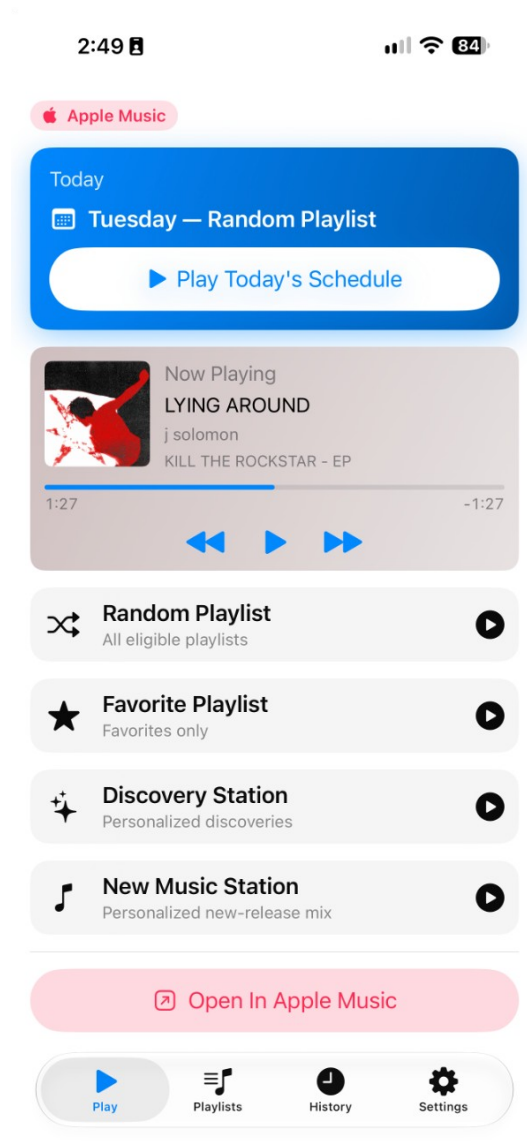


Figure 4 - Smart DJ Play screen on iPhone. The Now Playing panel shows artwork, track information, a song-time progress bar with elapsed and remaining time, and previous, play/pause, and next controls; the bottom tabs provide access to Play, Playlists, History, and Settings.

7. How random selection works

Smart DJ does not simply choose any playlist. It first creates an eligible pool.

- Special stations (Discovery Station and New Music Station) are excluded from ordinary random selection.
- The 10 most recently selected ordinary playlists are excluded when possible.
- Outside December, playlists marked Christmas are excluded.
- If those exclusions leave no eligible playlists, the recent-history exclusion is relaxed while the Christmas rule remains in effect.
- The final playlist is selected randomly from the remaining eligible pool.

December behavior: In December, Christmas playlists are eligible for random and Favorite selection.

8. Playlist management — Mac

16. Open Playlists from the sidebar.
17. Use Search playlists to narrow the list.

18. Use Import from Music or Import from Spotify to refresh the catalog from the selected music service.
19. Edit a playlist name directly in the table.
20. Use the Favorite switch to include or exclude a playlist from Favorite selection.
21. Use the Christmas switch to classify a playlist as seasonal.
22. Enter the stored Apple Music link or Spotify URI/URL for Discovery Station and New Music Station. For Spotify, a Spotify URI is preferred when available. These special stations are catalog resources rather than ordinary playlists in the user's personal library, so Smart DJ requires the stored identifier to locate the exact resource.
23. Select a playlist in the table, then click the visible Play button to start that playlist.
24. Choose Validate to check for common data problems.
25. Choose Save when available to commit playlist-management changes; shared Smart DJ configuration changes on macOS are written to iCloud Key-Value Store.

Playlist management — iPhone/iPad

26. Open the Playlists tab.
27. Use Search to find a playlist.
28. Tap a playlist to edit it. To play a playlist directly, swipe the playlist row to the right to reveal the green Play action, then tap Play.
29. Set Favorite and/or Christmas as appropriate.
30. For Apple Music, playback is handled directly by Smart DJ. Discovery Station and New Music Station use the stored Apple Music catalog URL; no separately created Apple Shortcut is required.
31. Tap Done to save the edited record. On iOS, changes to shared Smart DJ configuration are written to iCloud Key-Value Store.
32. Use the + button to add a new playlist record when needed.

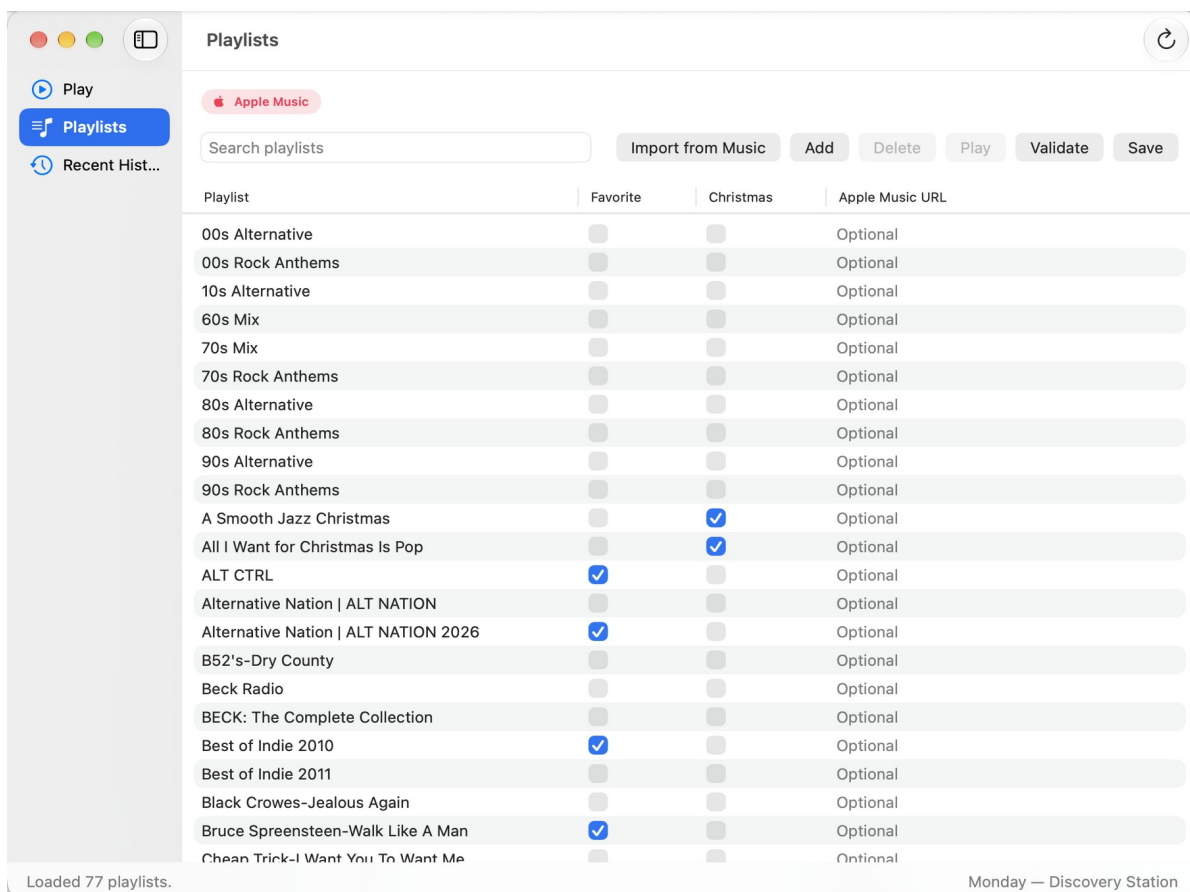


Figure 5 - Playlist Management on macOS. Select a playlist and click Play to start it; you can also search or import playlists, classify them as Favorite or Christmas, validate the catalog, and save changes.

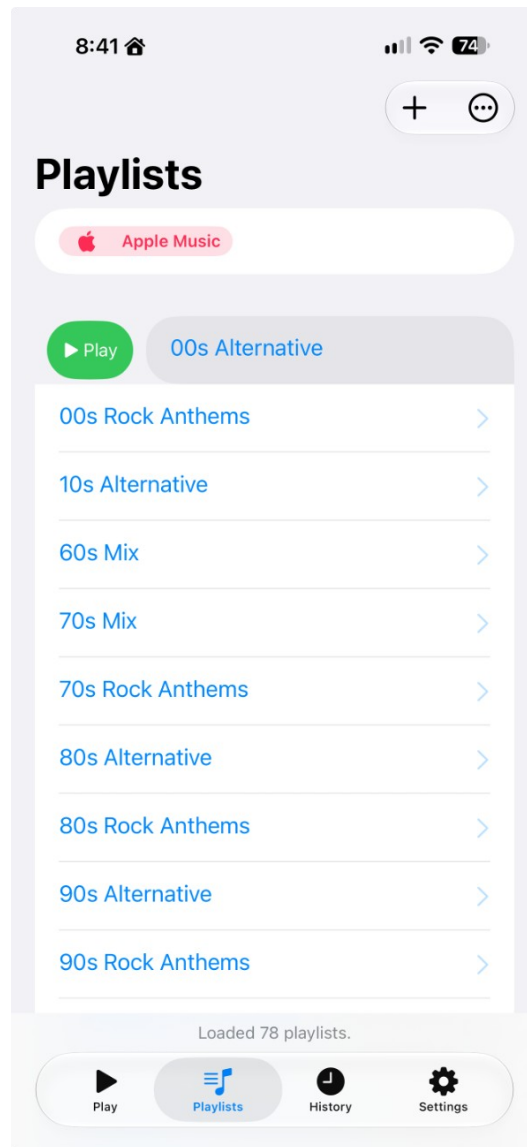


Figure 6 - Playlist Library on iPhone. Swipe a playlist row to the right to reveal the green Play action, then tap Play to start that playlist. Tap the playlist name to edit it; use the + button to add a record and the menu for additional management functions.

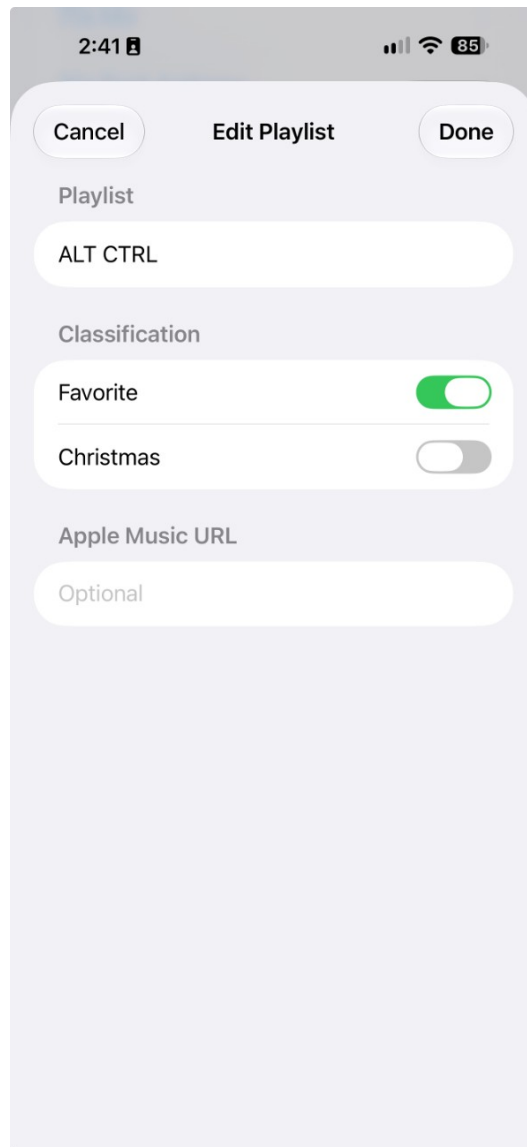


Figure 7 - Edit Playlist on iPhone. Favorite and Christmas switches control Smart DJ classification. The Apple Music URL field is available when a catalog URL is needed; ordinary library playlists can leave it blank.

Playlist playback and classification on tvOS/watchOS: On tvOS, tap the highlighted playlist to play it. Long-press the highlighted row to open a context menu with Mark as Favorite and Mark as Christmas. On watchOS, tap a playlist row to play it; swipe the row to reveal a yellow Favorite toggle and a cyan Christmas toggle. A snowflake icon identifies playlists marked Christmas. Discovery Station/New Music Station URLs and manual playlist-link overrides remain read-only on tvOS/watchOS because those platforms do not provide a per-row URL editor.

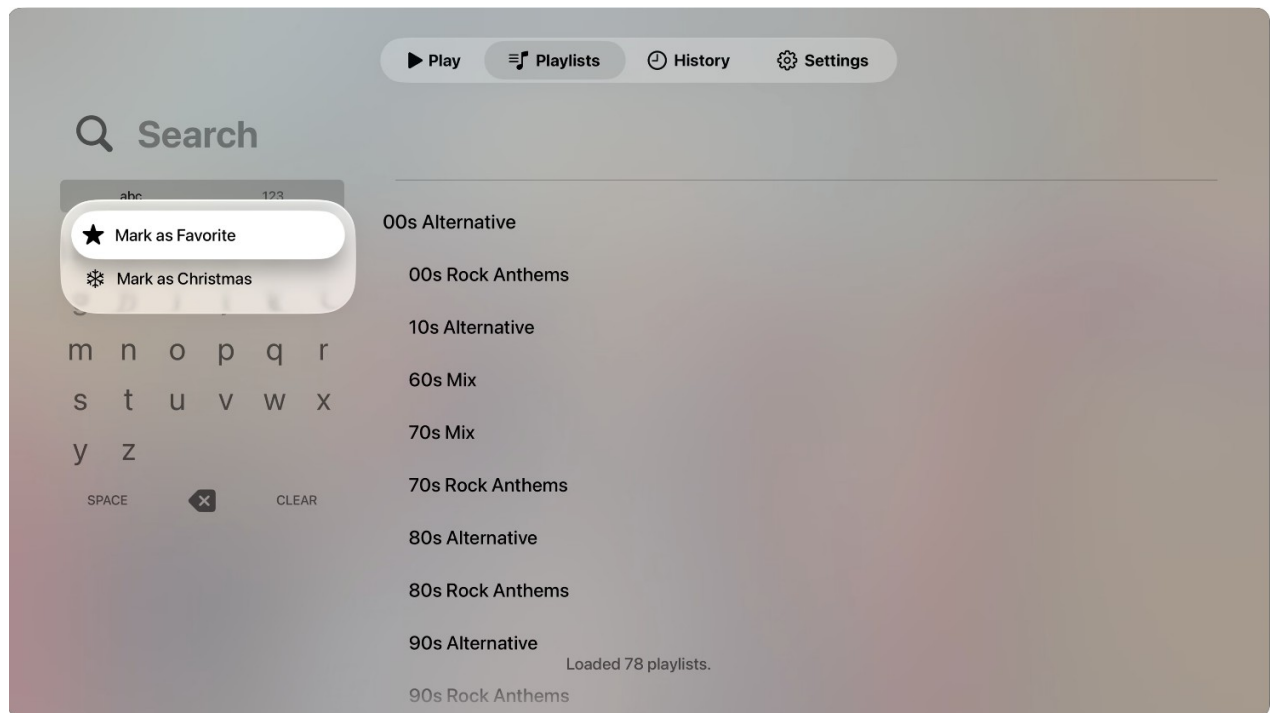


Figure 8 - Playlist Actions on Apple TV. Tap the highlighted playlist to play it. Long-press to open the context menu, then choose Mark as Favorite or Mark as Christmas.

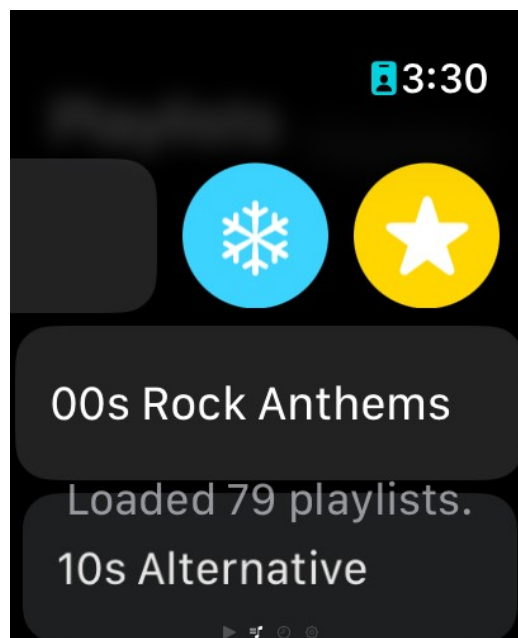


Figure 9 - Playlist Actions on Apple Watch. Tap a playlist to play it. Swipe the row to reveal the cyan Christmas toggle and yellow Favorite toggle.

8.1 Configuring Discovery Station and New Music Station links

Discovery Station and New Music Station require a stored catalog identifier. Ordinary playlists are normally played by finding the playlist by name in the user's library. These two special stations are catalog resources, so Smart DJ cannot resolve them by name alone. The stored Apple Music URL or Spotify URI/URL tells Smart DJ exactly which catalog resource to play.

Important: copy the link for the station or playlist itself - not the link for an individual song that happens to be playing. For Spotify, use a Spotify URI when the desktop app offers one; a normal Spotify web link remains an acceptable fallback.

Apple Music - find and copy the link

33. Open the Apple Music app on Mac, iPhone, or iPad.
34. Navigate to the Discovery Station or New Music resource you want Smart DJ to use. Open the station/resource page itself so that you are sharing the station, not the currently playing song.
35. Open the More (•••) or Share menu for that station/resource and choose Share, then Copy Link. Apple Music supplies a music.apple.com catalog URL.
36. Return to Smart DJ. On Mac, open Playlists and find the row named Discovery Station or New Music Station. Paste the copied link into the Apple Music URL column for that row.
37. On iPhone/iPad, open Playlists, tap the corresponding special-station entry to edit it, and paste the copied Apple Music link into its URL field. Tap Done.
38. Save the change, run Validate, and then test the station from the Play screen.

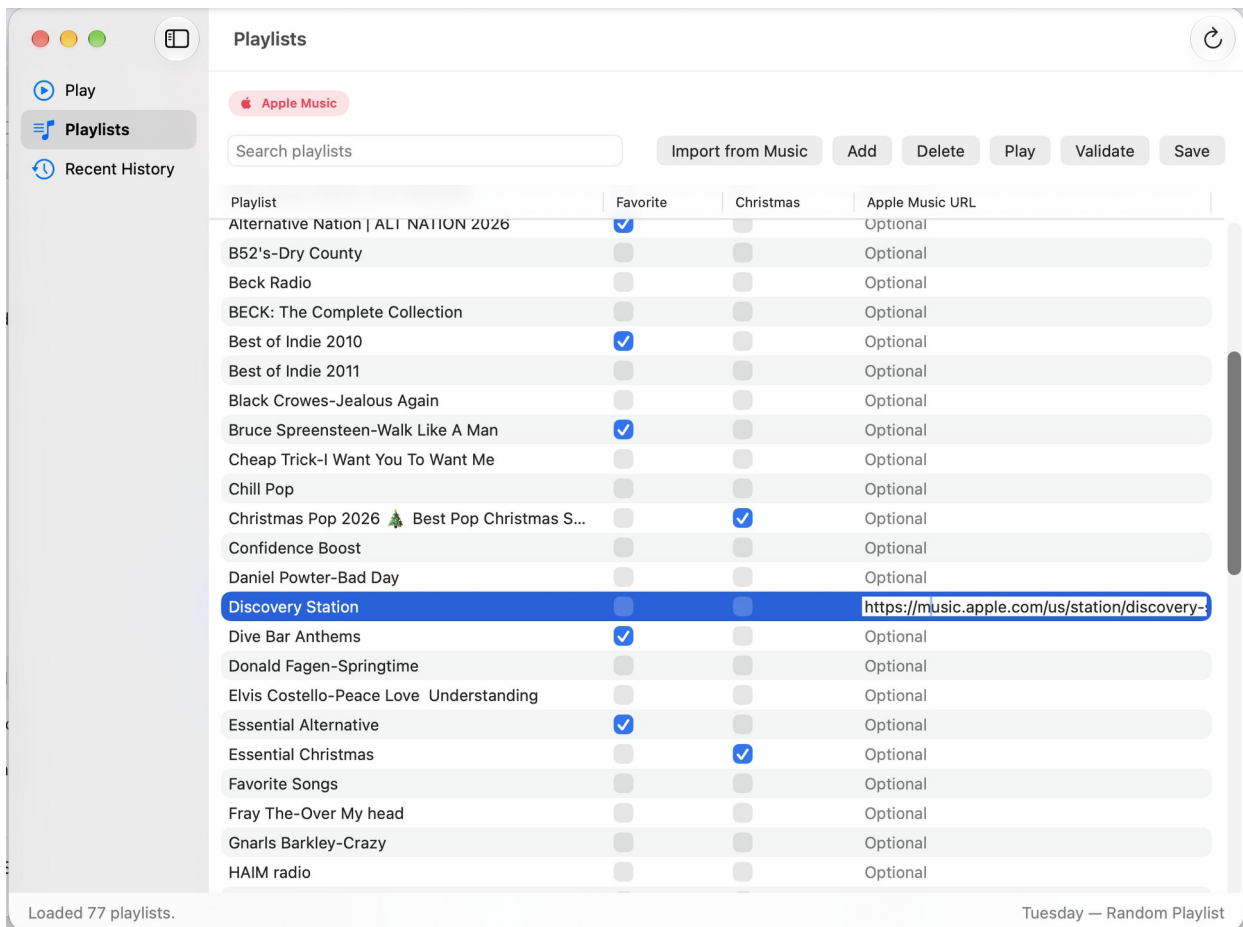


Figure 10 - Apple Music special-station link on macOS. The Discovery Station row is selected and its copied Apple Music catalog URL is pasted into the Apple Music URL column. The same procedure is used for New Music Station.

Spotify - prefer a Spotify URI

A Spotify URI is the preferred identifier because it directly identifies the Spotify resource in the form `spotify:type:id` (for example, `spotify:playlist:...`). Smart DJ can also use the corresponding Spotify web URL when a URI is not available.

39. Open the Spotify desktop app on the Mac and navigate to the playlist/resource you want Smart DJ to use for Discovery Station or New Music Station.
40. Open the resource's **...** menu (or right-click it), choose Share, and hold the Option (⌘) key. Spotify changes the normal Copy link command to Copy Spotify URI. Choose Copy Spotify URI.
41. If you are using Spotify on iPhone/iPad and Copy Spotify URI is not offered, use Share > Copy Link instead. The normal Spotify URL is an acceptable fallback.
42. Return to Smart DJ. On Mac, open Playlists and find Discovery Station or New Music Station. Paste the copied Spotify URI into the Spotify Playlist URL field for that row. Although the current column heading says URL, the field accepts the preferred Spotify URI as well as a web URL.
43. On iPhone/iPad, open Playlists, tap the corresponding special-station entry, and paste the Spotify URI or copied link into its URL/link field. Tap Done.
44. Save the change, run Validate, make sure Spotify is connected and an active Spotify Connect playback device is available, and then test the station from the Play screen.

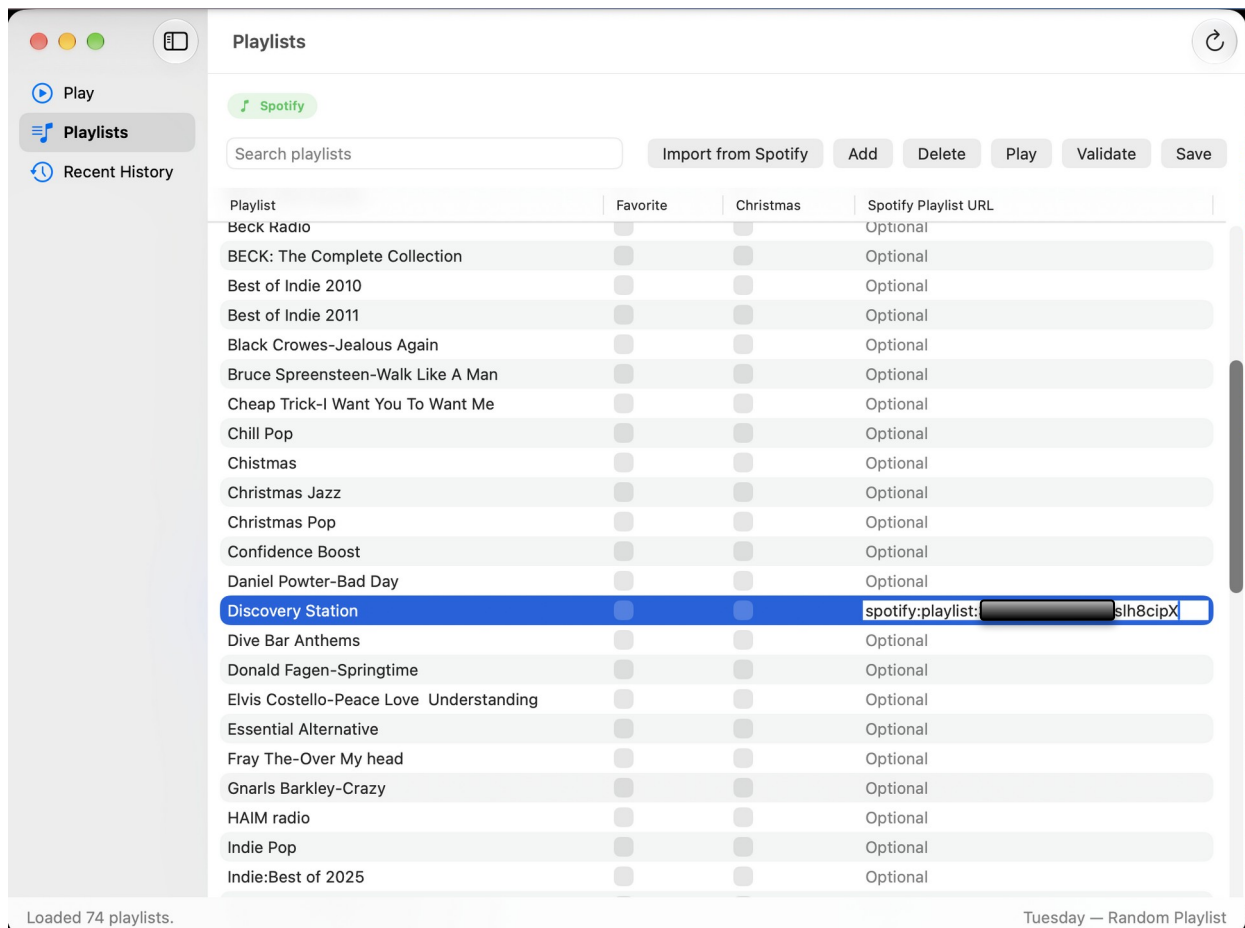


Figure 11 - Spotify special-station identifier on macOS. The Discovery Station row is selected and a Spotify URI is pasted into the Spotify Playlist URL field. Spotify URI is preferred; a Spotify web URL can be used as a fallback.

Which identifier should I use?

Music service	Preferred value	Where it is used
Apple Music	Apple Music URL (Copy Link)	Discovery Station and New Music Station
Spotify	Spotify URI (preferred); Spotify web URL as fallback	Discovery Station and New Music Station

After changing either special-station identifier, use Save and Validate before relying on Today's Schedule. If playback fails, re-open the music service and confirm that the copied identifier belongs to the intended station/resource rather than to a track.

9. Shared data, synchronization, and backup

Shared data	Storage	Behavior
Favorites / Christmas	iCloud Key-Value Store	Read by all supported platforms; writable on macOS/iOS and for Favorite/Christmas toggles on tvOS/watchOS
Discovery / New Music	iCloud Key-Value Store	Read by all supported platforms; writable on macOS/iOS; read-only on tvOS/watchOS
Playlist / link data	iCloud Key-Value Store	Read by all supported platforms; writable on macOS/iOS; playlist links are read-only on tvOS/watchOS
Recent History	iCloud Key-Value Store	Shared recent-selection history
Backup / restore	Exported .json file	Manual snapshot via Export Backup; restore via Import Backup

Smart DJ uses iCloud Key-Value Store as the primary shared store for Favorites, Christmas classifications, Discovery Station data, New Music Station data, playlist/link data, and Recent History.

Favorites, Christmas classifications, Discovery Station data, New Music Station data, playlist/link data, and Recent History are stored in iCloud Key-Value Store. All supported platforms read this shared data when Smart DJ starts. macOS and iOS can edit the full supported shared configuration, while tvOS/watchOS can update Favorite and Christmas classifications.

Backup and restore: Smart DJ provides Export Backup and Import Backup functions. Export Backup writes a manual snapshot of Smart DJ data to a .json file; Import Backup restores a previously exported snapshot. This provides a portable backup independent of normal iCloud Key-Value synchronization.

On iPhone/iPad, the Backup section is located in Settings below the Weekly Schedule. The exported snapshot includes Favorites, Christmas classifications, playback history, links, and the weekly schedule.

10. Validation

Use Validate before relying on newly edited data. The validator checks for duplicate playlist names, classification entries that do not correspond to an ordinary playlist, and missing identifiers for Discovery Station or New Music Station. An Apple Music URL or Spotify URI/URL is required for each special station because it cannot be resolved from the ordinary playlist library by name.

A successful validation reports that no problems were found. Validation does not replace saving; use Save after making changes.

11. Recent History

Recent History shows the newest selection first. The history is limited to the 10 most recently selected ordinary playlists. Recent History is part of the shared iCloud Key-Value data so supported platforms can use the same recent-selection information.

Discovery Station and New Music Station are not added to the ordinary-playlist history.

On Mac and iOS, Clear History removes the stored Recent History from the shared key-value data. This makes recently played ordinary playlists eligible again.

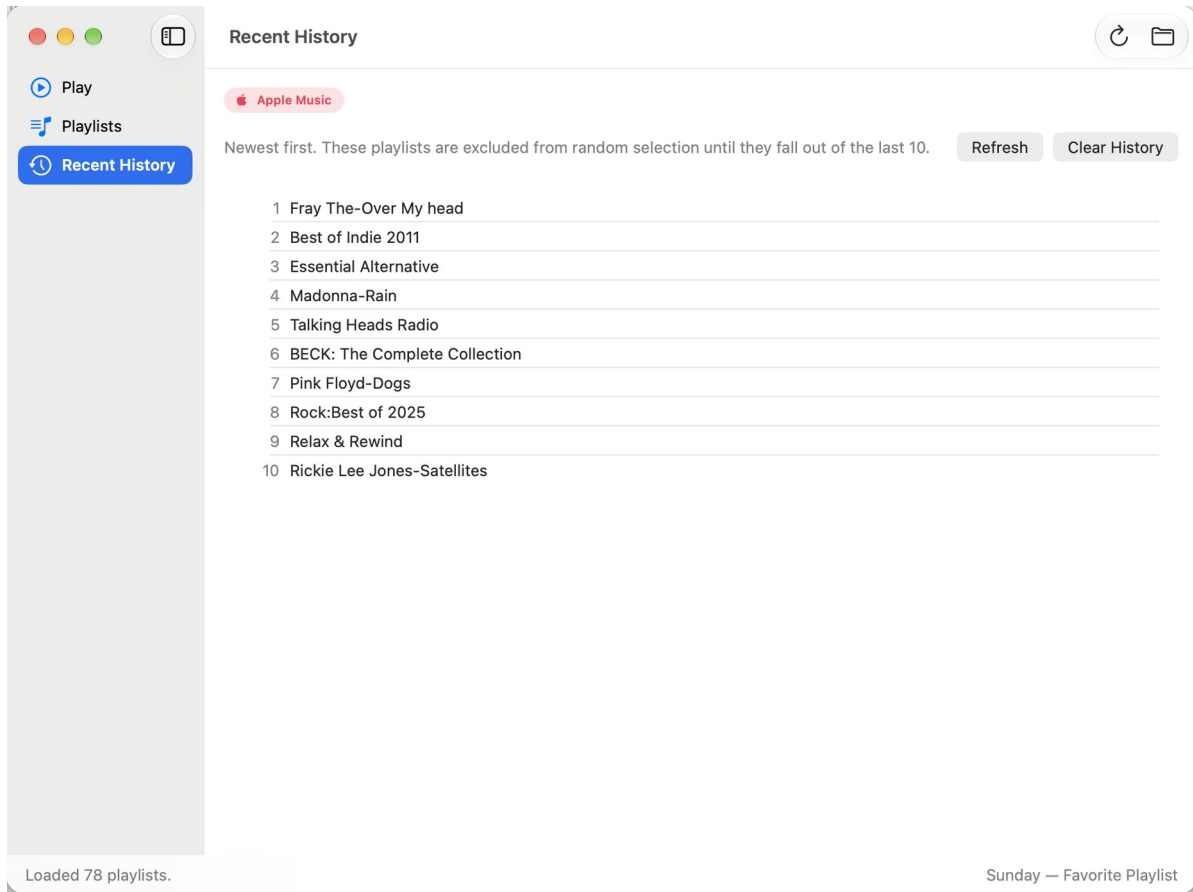


Figure 12 - Recent History on macOS. Smart DJ shows the 10 most recently selected ordinary playlists, newest first, and excludes them from random selection when possible.

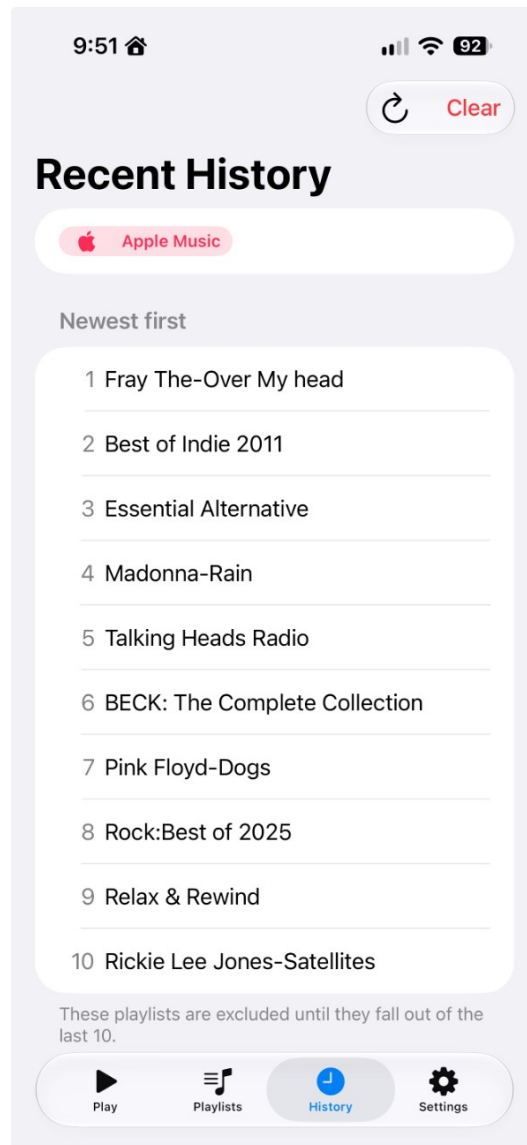


Figure 13 - Recent History on iPhone. Refresh reloads the displayed history; Clear removes the stored history so those playlists become eligible again.

12. Spotify setup

Spotify support on Mac and iOS uses Spotify's Web API with OAuth authorization. Playback control requires an active Spotify Connect device and a Spotify Premium account.

45. Create a Spotify developer application (<https://developer.spotify.com/dashboard>).
46. Copy its Client ID.
47. In Smart DJ Settings, choose Spotify.
48. Enter the Client ID.
49. Configure the Spotify application's redirect URI as **smartdj://spotify-callback**.
50. Tap/click Connect Spotify and complete Spotify authorization.
51. Return to Smart DJ and confirm that the Spotify section reports Connected.

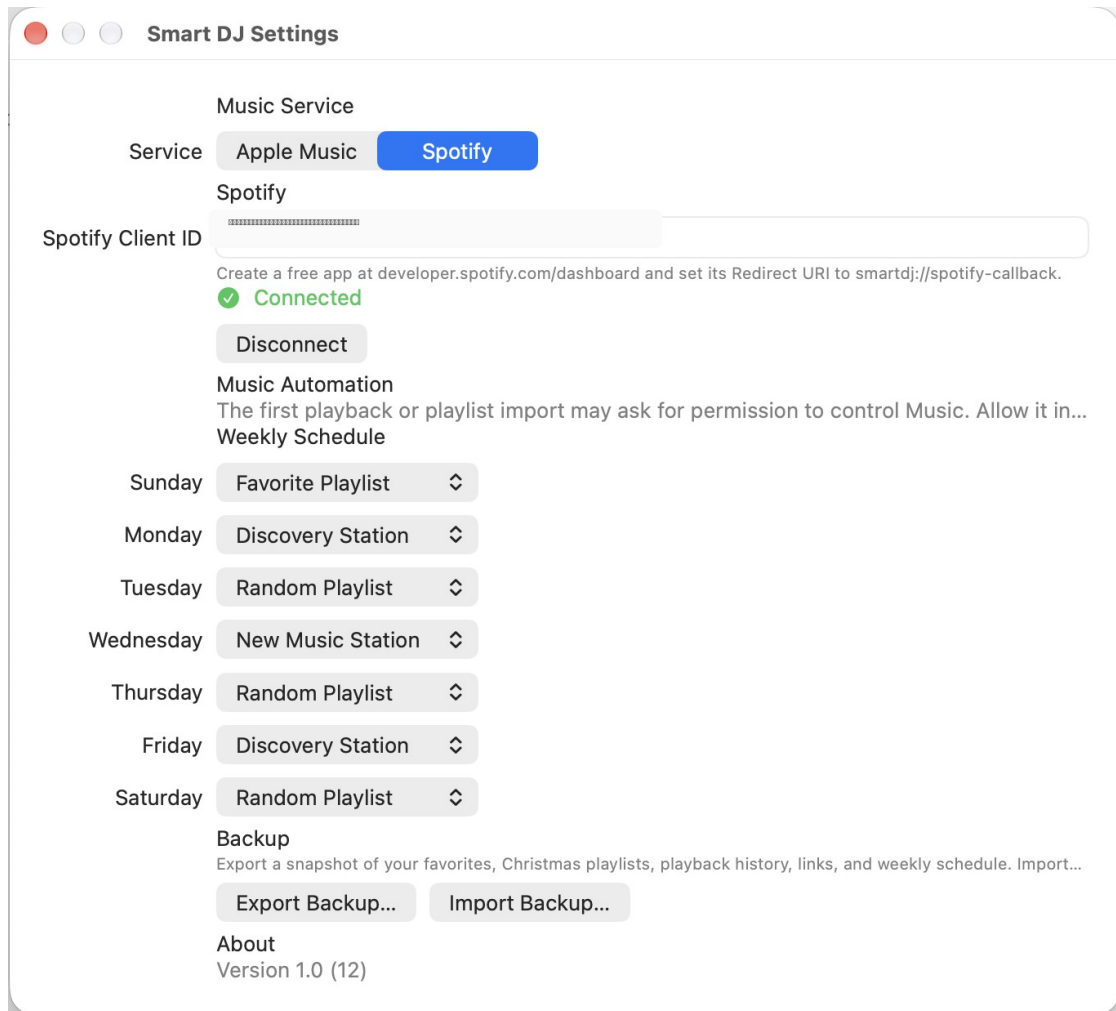


Figure 14 - Spotify Configuration on macOS. Enter the Spotify Client ID, complete authorization, and confirm the green Connected status. The Client ID is obscured in this manual for privacy. The weekly schedule and JSON Export/Import backup controls remain available when Spotify is selected.

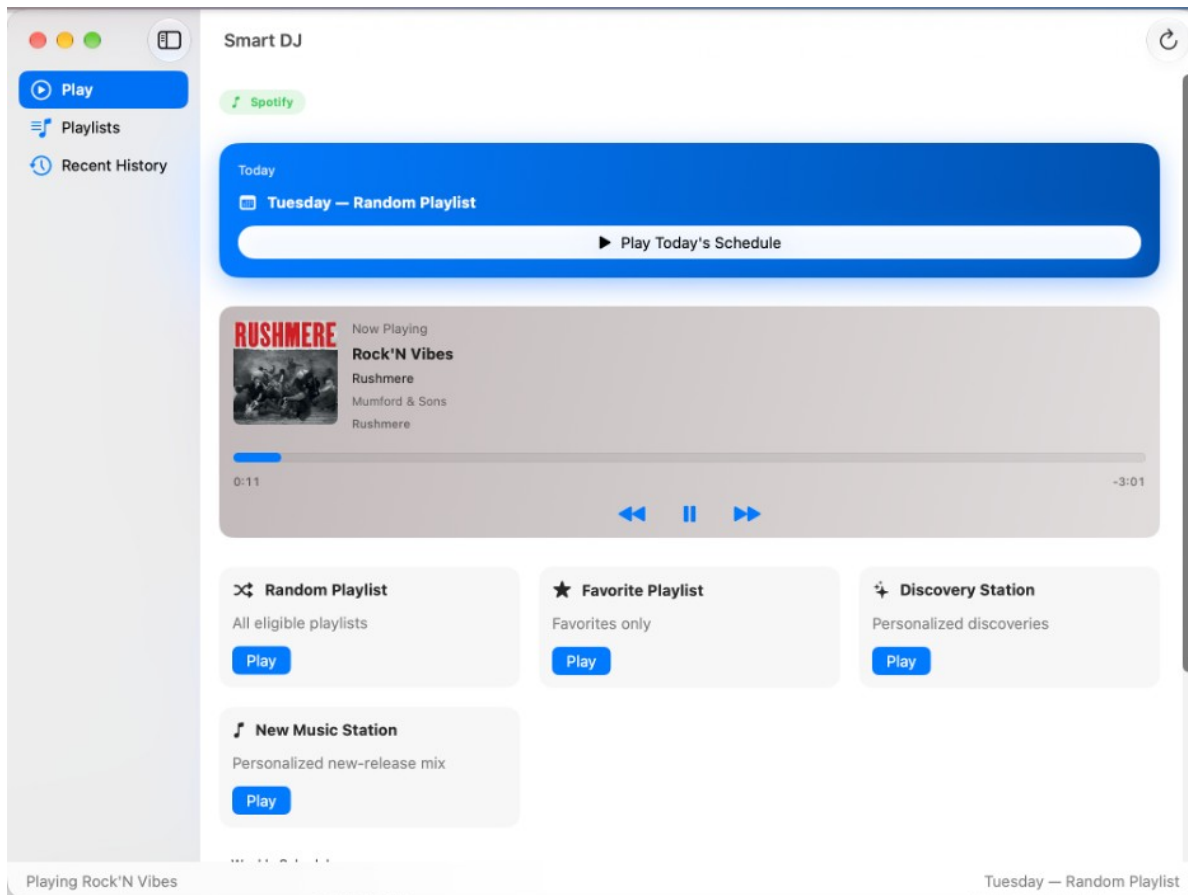


Figure 16 - Smart DJ Play screen with Spotify selected on macOS. The Now Playing panel shows the current playlist and track information, a song-time progress bar with elapsed and remaining time, and playback controls, while the playback workflow and weekly schedule remain consistent across supported music services.

Security: Spotify access and refresh tokens are stored in the device keychain rather than in the Smart DJ data files.

13. Siri, Shortcuts, Spotlight, and App Intents

The project defines five direct Smart DJ actions:

- Play Smart DJ Today
- Play Random Smart DJ Playlist
- Play Smart DJ Favorite
- Play Smart DJ Discovery Station
- Play Smart DJ New Music Station

All five Smart DJ App Intent actions, including Discovery Station and New Music Station, are available consistently across supported platforms. Each action routes through the same Smart DJ deep-link mechanism to the corresponding in-app playback mode.

There is also a parameterized action named Play Smart DJ by Mode. These App Intents are compiled into Smart DJ itself and can be exposed automatically as App Shortcuts in Siri, the Shortcuts app, Spotlight, and other supported system surfaces. No separate .shortcut workflow needs to be created or maintained. This integration is optional: normal in-app playback works independently of Siri and the Shortcuts app.

When an App Intent is invoked, Smart DJ routes the request to the corresponding in-app playback mode. Discovery Station and New Music Station then use the stored catalog identifier and the same in-app playback path used by the Play screen. Smart DJ also registers a custom smartdj:// URL scheme that can address each playback mode directly.

Smart DJ URL Scheme

The following deep links open Smart DJ and request the corresponding playback mode. They use the same in-app playback path as selecting the mode from the Play screen.

Smart DJ action	Deep link
Today's Schedule	smartdj://play/today
Random Playlist	smartdj://play/random
Favorite Playlist	smartdj://play/favorite
Discovery Station	smartdj://play/discovery
New Music Station	smartdj://play/newmusic

The value after smartdj://play/ identifies the requested Smart DJ mode. These deep links are separate from Apple Music catalog URLs and Spotify URIs/URLs, which identify music resources rather than Smart DJ actions.

14. iPhone/iPad Home Screen widgets

Marketing Version 1.1 adds two WidgetKit Home Screen widgets on iPhone/iPad. They are optional system surfaces; the normal Smart DJ app continues to provide the complete playback and configuration experience.

Smart DJ Quick Play

The Smart DJ Quick Play widget provides direct access to all five Smart DJ playback modes: Today's Schedule, Random, Favorite, Discovery, and New Music. Its buttons use the same smartdj://play/... deep links documented above, opening Smart DJ and routing the request through the normal in-app playback path. Quick Play is available in the medium and large Home Screen widget families.

Smart DJ Now Playing

The Smart DJ Now Playing widget is available as a medium Home Screen widget. It displays the current track title and artist, includes album artwork when available, and provides previous, play/pause, and next controls. The main app shares the current Now Playing state and resized artwork with the widget through the Smart DJ App Group. The widget refreshes when the app detects a track or playback-state change.

The Now Playing widget's transport controls use Apple's SystemMusicPlayer on iOS and therefore control the Apple Music playback session. The Quick Play widget can still launch any Smart DJ mode through the app using the currently selected music service.

To add a widget, touch and hold the iPhone/iPad Home Screen, choose the system option to add a widget, find Smart DJ, select Smart DJ Quick Play or Smart DJ Now Playing, choose an available size, and add it to the Home Screen.

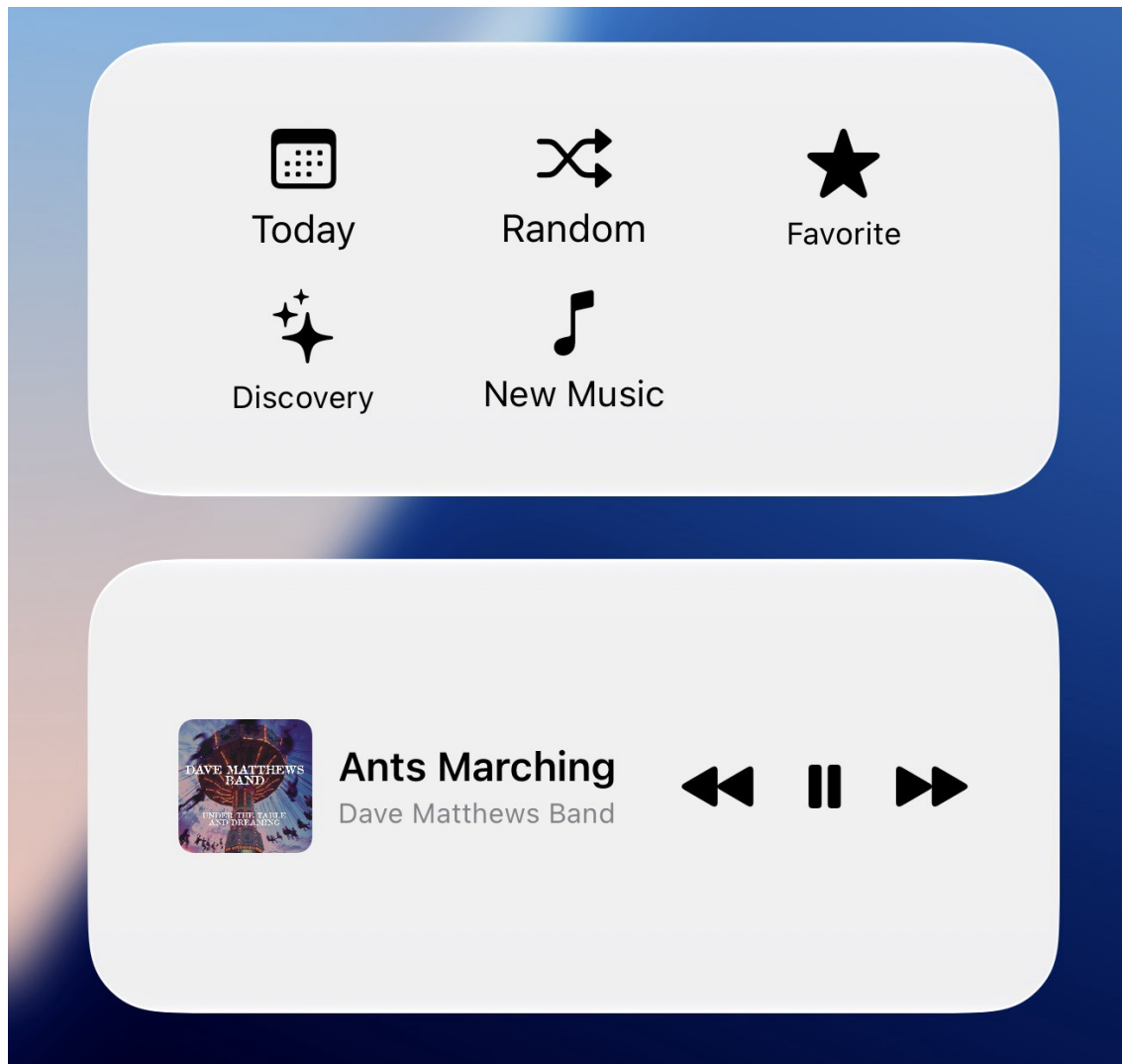


Figure - Smart DJ Home Screen widgets on iPhone. Quick Play provides direct access to all five Smart DJ playback modes. Now Playing displays the current track, artist, and artwork with previous, play/pause, and next controls.

15. CarPlay

The iOS project declares CarPlay audio support and includes a CarPlay scene delegate. When CarPlay connects, Smart DJ loads its shared configuration and, if nothing is already playing, starts Today's Schedule automatically. It does not interrupt music that is already playing. Smart DJ also republishes Now Playing information so CarPlay's Now Playing surfaces stay synchronized as tracks advance or playback pauses/resumes. The normal Smart DJ app remains the place to configure playlists and settings; shared configuration is supplied through iCloud Key-Value Store.



Figure 17 - Smart DJ in Apple CarPlay. The simplified in-car interface provides quick access to Today's Schedule and the four Smart DJ playback modes while standard CarPlay Now Playing controls remain available.

16. Platform differences

Special-station playback differs by platform because Discovery Station and New Music Station are catalog resources, not ordinary library playlists. Apple Music uses a MusicKit catalog request on macOS/iOS/tvOS, while watchOS opens the stored Apple Music link directly. Spotify uses the stored link through Spotify's Web API on macOS/iOS only. iPhone/iPad additionally supports the Smart DJ Quick Play and Now Playing Home Screen widgets.

Feature	macOS	iPhone/iPad	tvOS	watchOS
Music service	Apple Music / Spotify	Apple Music / Spotify	Apple Music	Apple Music
Apple Music playback	In-app MusicKit catalog request	In-app MusicKit catalog request	In-app MusicKit catalog request	Opens stored Apple Music link directly
Spotify playback	Stored link via Spotify's Web API	Stored link via Spotify's Web API	Not supported	Not supported
Shared iCloud data	Read / write	Read / write	Read; Favorite/Christmas write	Read; Favorite/Christmas write
Playlist editing	Full table editing	List + editor	Tap plays; long-press Favorite/Christmas menu. Links read-only.	Tap plays; swipe for Favorite/Christmas toggles. Links read-only.

Now Playing controls	Yes	Yes	Previous / play-pause / next controls; no duplicated track metadata	Not duplicated in Smart DJ
CarPlay	N/A	Yes	N/A	N/A
Ordinary playlist playback	Select row, click Play	Swipe right, tap Play	Tap row	Tap row
Discovery / New Music	Stored URL identifies catalog resource	Stored URL identifies catalog resource	Stored URL identifies catalog resource	Opens stored Apple Music link directly
Home Screen widgets	Not included	Quick Play (medium/large); Now Playing (medium)	Not included	Not included

17. Troubleshooting

Shared data does not appear or is out of date

Confirm iCloud is available and restart Smart DJ so it can read the shared key-value data at startup.

Music playlists are missing

Confirm the selected Music Service, confirm that the app has permission to access the music library, and reload the data. On Mac, use Import from Music/Spotify from the Playlists screen.

A playlist cannot be found

The stored playlist name must match the music-service playlist name. Smart DJ compares names without regard to leading/trailing whitespace and letter case, but the playlist still must exist.

Spotify says it is not configured

Enter the Spotify Client ID in Settings.

Spotify says there is no active device

Open Spotify on the desired playback device and make sure it is available as a Spotify Connect device, then try again.

Discovery/New Music does not play

Verify that the stored URL is configured for Discovery Station or New Music Station. On Apple Music for macOS, iOS, and tvOS, Smart DJ uses that URL to identify and fetch the exact catalog resource with MusicKit; on watchOS, the Apple Music link opens directly. For Spotify on macOS/iOS, verify both the stored URL and Spotify connection. Run Validate to identify missing special-station URLs.

Changes do not appear on another device

Confirm iCloud is available on both devices. Smart DJ reads the shared key-value data when it starts, so restart or relaunch the app on the device that has not yet reflected the change. macOS and iOS write the full supported shared configuration; tvOS/watchOS can write Favorite and Christmas classification changes.

Backup or restore Smart DJ data

In Settings, use Export Backup to create a .json snapshot of Smart DJ data and Import Backup to restore a previously exported snapshot. Backup is manual rather than automatic protection.

18. Recommended operating procedure

52. Confirm iCloud is available so Smart DJ can read the shared configuration and Recent History.
53. Choose the music service before editing playlist data.
54. Import/reload the music-service playlists.
55. Mark Favorite and Christmas playlists.
56. Verify the Discovery Station and New Music Station links.
57. Run Validate.
58. Save or finish edits as appropriate; on macOS and iOS, shared-data changes are written to iCloud Key-Value Store.
59. Test each of the five Smart DJ modes.
60. Let the weekday schedule handle routine daily selection.

19. Reference: current app behavior

This manual describes Smart DJ Marketing Version 1.1, Build 54, including iPhone/iPad Quick Play and Now Playing Home Screen widgets, iCloud Key-Value synchronization of shared configuration and Recent History, JSON Export Backup/Import Backup, current CarPlay behavior, and current playlist playback/classification controls on tvOS and watchOS. User-interface wording may change as the app evolves.

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